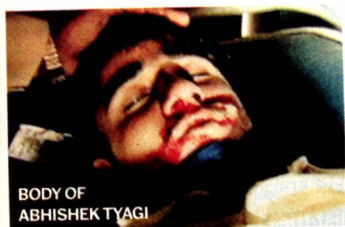




THE PATNA KILLERS
IN POLICE CUSTODY

KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN



BODY OF
ABHISHEK TYAGI

objectionable movie of a minor girl on his cellphone.

■ April 2009: A minor boy, along with his friend, kills a 16-year-old boy in Karawal Nagar in Delhi as the victim was trying to befriend the girl with whom the minor had an affair.

■ April 2009: A 16-year-old boy was convicted for sending a prank email, threatening to blow up Andheri railway station.

■ March 2009: A 17-year-old girl and her boyfriend kill a 35-year-old ad filmmaker in Mumbai. She was having an affair with the victim.

■ March 2009: A five-year-old girl is allegedly raped by a minor at Trilokpuri in Delhi.

■ March 2008: A 17-year-old girl kills

her close friend by poisoning her and then tries to commit suicide. She was angry because the victim got intimate with her boyfriend.

■ December 2007: Abhishek Tyagi, a Class VIII student of the Euro International School in Gurgaon, is shot by his classmates Akash Yadav and Vikas Yadav at point-blank range with their father's licenced gun.

■ December 2007: A 17-year-old boy allegedly abducts and kills his friend of the same age by shoving his elbow in the victim's throat in WWE style. He wanted to demand a ransom of Rs 5 lakh.

■ June 2007: A teenager in Mumbai murders his nine-year-old friend over a tiff and hides the body in his bedroom for two days.



SHE KILLED
HER 35-YEAR-
OLD LOVER

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in a fit of frenzied, rash driving, most children feel no remorse," adds Shetty.

Uncensored exposure to the Internet, television and other content not suited for their age is another menace. Social networking sites like Orkut and Facebook, for instance, give an insight into what most teenagers are engaging with. From communities like 'hacking is not a crime' and 'stunting is not a crime' to groups like 'legal crime club,' which urges its members to "do your first legalised crime," it is a clear case of too much too soon for most youngsters. "For instance, the macho man in films takes pride in hitting someone, driving a car without a licence or even brazenly misbehaving with a woman. For children, it's just a 'cool' act that they want to copy," says Shyama Chona, principal, Delhi Public School, R.K. Puram. Adds Lorna D'Mello, the principal of St. Thomas High School, Goregaon, "Unstable families and the changing social situations play an important role in making these children aggressive. The biggest problem, however, is that a child does anything to get what he wants."

Juvenile delinquency is not limited to a single class. In fact, it spreads across social strata and geographical locations. In Tier II cities like Chandigarh and Ahmedabad as well, cases of minors breaking the law are rampant. Take the case of 17-year-old Mayur Pahwa, a resident of Chandigarh, who was sent to a juvenile home for allegedly raping, threatening and making an objectionable movie of a minor girl on his cellphone. Or Ahmedabad-based Promit Patel, 17, who killed his friend for a Rs 5-lakh ransom. Inspired by the wrestling matches he had seen on television, Patel choked his friend, Lokesh Dadwani, to death by shoving an elbow into his throat. Says K.I.P. Singh, deputy superintendent of police, crime branch, Chandigarh: "If the children come from affluent families, the parents don't want their offences to be publicised. We often receive requests to not put the cases on record." However, when cases involve "less powerful" families, most children end up paying a visit to state-run observation centres, only to be released on bail later. Joint Commissioner of Mumbai Police, Law